

ENGLISH

GRAMMAR

SUBJECT-VERB CONCORD

Lecture - 1

Subject-Verb Concord

1 - 1 | Verb forms (H/W)

- Subject and verb should be in agreement.
- A singular subject takes a singular verb and a plural subject takes a plural verb.

- Rich people have made huge donations.
- The mosquito is biting the child.
- The sportsperson denies the rumours.

|

S + V + O

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agrees

Sub-Singular	Sub-Plural
Verb-Singular	Verb-Plural

SS - SV
PS - PV

Subject-Verb Concord

1. Subject: Singular, Plural, & Collective

Singular subjects take singular verbs.

SINGULAR SUBJECTS + SINGULAR VERBS

Examples

(i) My cat **does not** like milk.

(i) My cat do not like milk. X

(ii) The Ship **has** a pink mast.

(ii) The Ship have a pink mast. X

Plural subjects take Plural verbs.

PLURAL SUBJECTS + PLURAL VERBS

Examples

(i) The tigers in the forest **meet** at the waterhole.

(i) The tigers in the forest meets at the waterhole. X

(ii) The balls **are** heavy and sink at the bottom.

(ii) The balls are heavy and sinks at the bottom. X

Subject-Verb Concord

Subjects that are ^SCollective Nouns take singular verbs

COLLECTIVE NOUNS + SINGULAR VERBS

Examples

(i) Go check if the fleet of ships has arrived.

(ii) The choir is known for its original compositions.

(i) Go check if the fleet of ships have arrived. X

(ii) The choir are known for their original compositions. X

Team^S has^S

SS - SV
PS - PV

S - COL. N (S)
V - ? (S)

Subject-Verb Concord

2. Nouns/ Pronouns Joined by 'and'

a

Subjects that are joined by 'and' take plural verbs

SUBJECT 1 AND SUBJECT 2 + PLURAL VERB

Examples

- (i) Apples and pears **belong** to the same family.
- (ii) Animals and plants **are** both important for our ecosystem.

- (i) Apples and pears belongs to the same family. ~~X~~
- (ii) Animals and plants is both important for our ecosystem. ~~X~~

SS - SV
PS - PV

$(1) + (1) = 2$
S $\rightarrow$ N₁ + N₂ = Plural
V - Plural =

Subject-Verb Concord

2. Nouns/Pronouns Joined by 'and': **exception**

b Sometimes two nouns are connected by 'and' but still represent a single entity.

NOUN AND NOUN + SINGULAR VERB

single entity

Bread & Butter.

Examples

(i) Milk and cereal **is** a popular American breakfast.

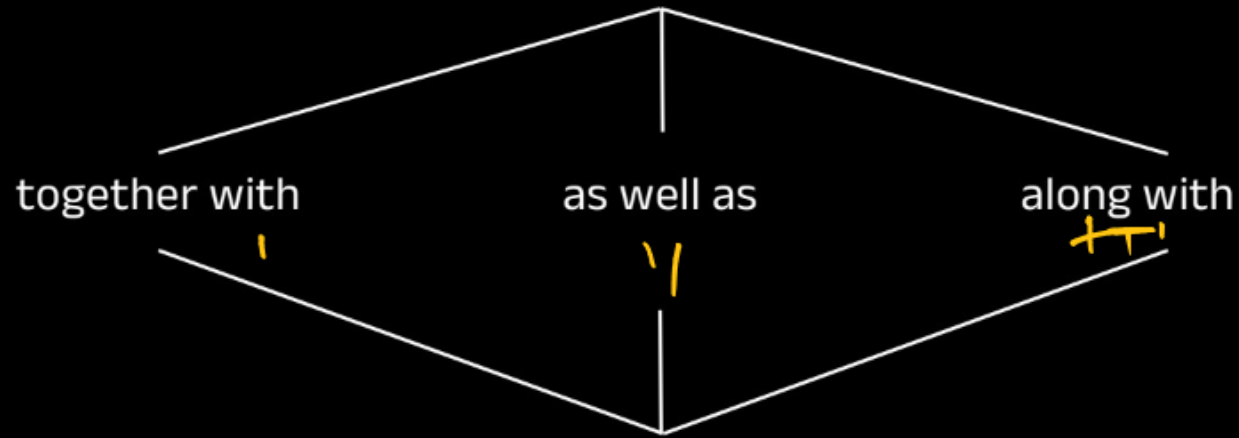
(ii) Salt and pepper **is** essential for any recipe.

(i) Milk and cereal are a popular American breakfast. ~~X~~

(ii) Salt and pepper are essential for any recipe. ~~X~~

Subject-Verb Concord

3. When two nouns are joined by



verb agrees with the first noun

Examples

(i) ^{S₁} I, ^{S₂} along with Deepak, ^V am going to see the exhibition.

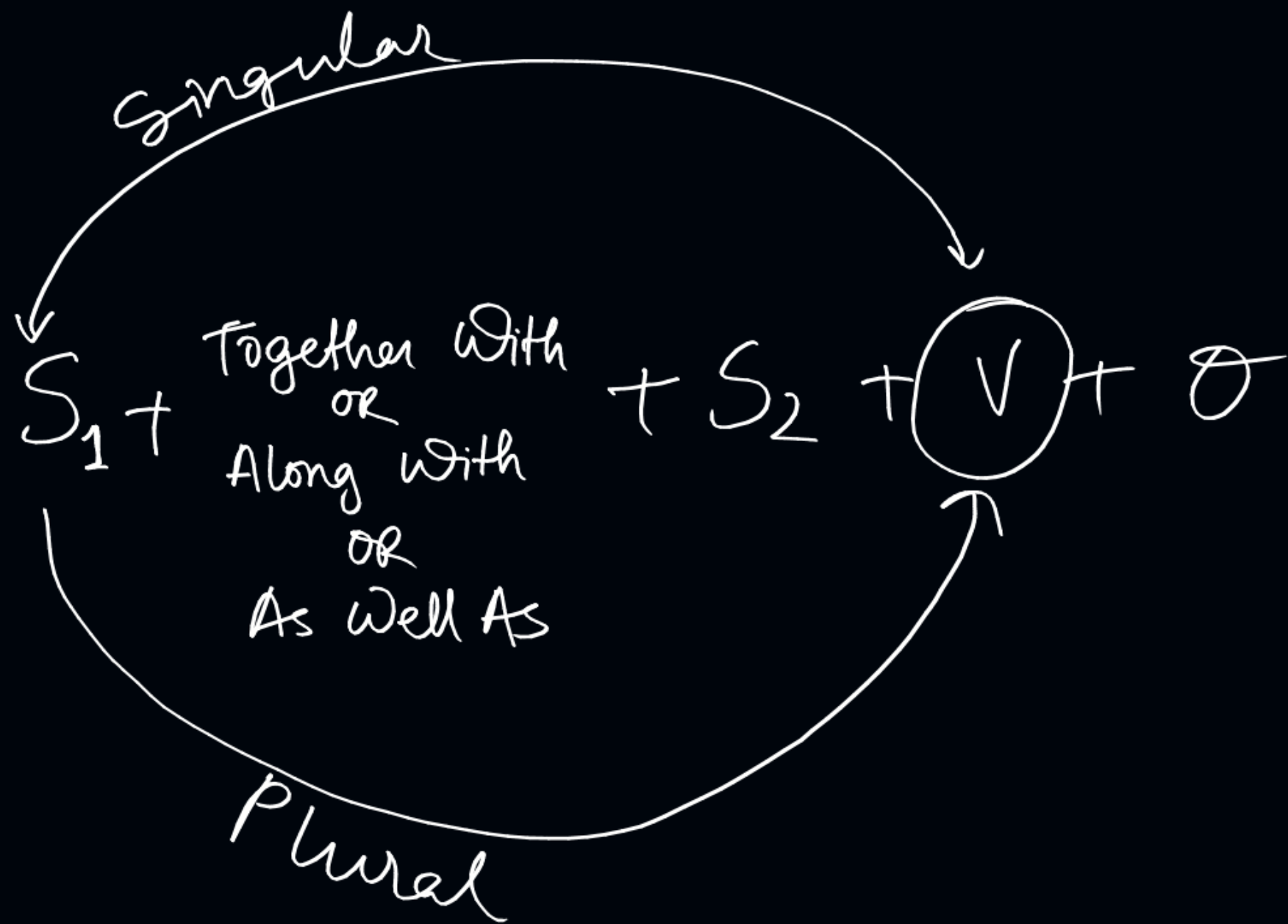
(i) I, along with Deepak, are going to see the exhibition.

SS - SV
PS - PV

$S_1 [as\ well\ as] S_2 + V + O$

^{S₁} The students ^{together with} ^{along with} ^{S₂} (as well as) the teacher ^{are} ^{is} supposed to attend the workshop

$S_1 + \overset{T.W}{A.W.A} + S_2 + \overset{T.W}{A.W} V + O$



Subject-Verb Concord

As well as, in addition to, together with, along with, besides etc
as well as
in addition to

+ verb according to the first noun.

together with
besides

Examples

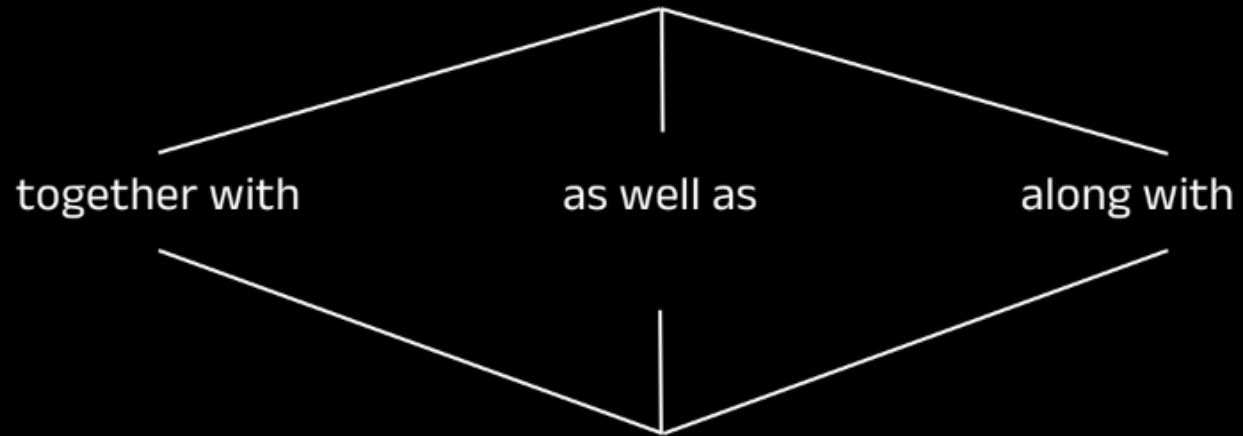
(i) The monk ^{S1} as well his disciples ^P ^{S2} is meditating in the sun.

(i) The monk as well his disciples are meditating in the sun. X

The disciples ^{S1} together with the monk ^{S2} are ^(P) meditating in the sun.

Subject-Verb Concord

3. When two nouns are joined by



verb agrees with the first noun

Examples

- (i) The children, together with the teacher, are practising hard.
- (ii) The cat as well as the mice is responsible for spilling the milk.

- (i) The children, together with the teacher, is practising hard.
- (ii) The cat as well as the mice are responsible for spilling the milk.

Subject-Verb Concord

4. Fractions/Money/Quantitative Items

FRACTIONS: the verb agrees with the WHOLE subject*

*singular subject: singular verb; plural subject: plural verb

Examples

(i) Three-fourth class is absent today.

(ii) One-fourth of the stock is missing.

(i) Three-fourth class are absent today.

(ii) One-fourth of the stock are missing.

SS - SV
PS - PV



① $\frac{1}{2}$ Half of the pizza
- left for me.

Subject-Verb Concord

4. Fractions/Money/Quantitative Items

distances, periods of time, sums of money, etc.: singular verbs

Examples

(i) Hundred cents is equal to one dollar.

(ii) Ten miles is a long distance to cover in an hour.

(i) Hundred cents are equal to one dollar.

(ii) Ten miles are a long distance to cover in an hour.

Face Value

=

14:48

2:48

4597

15km

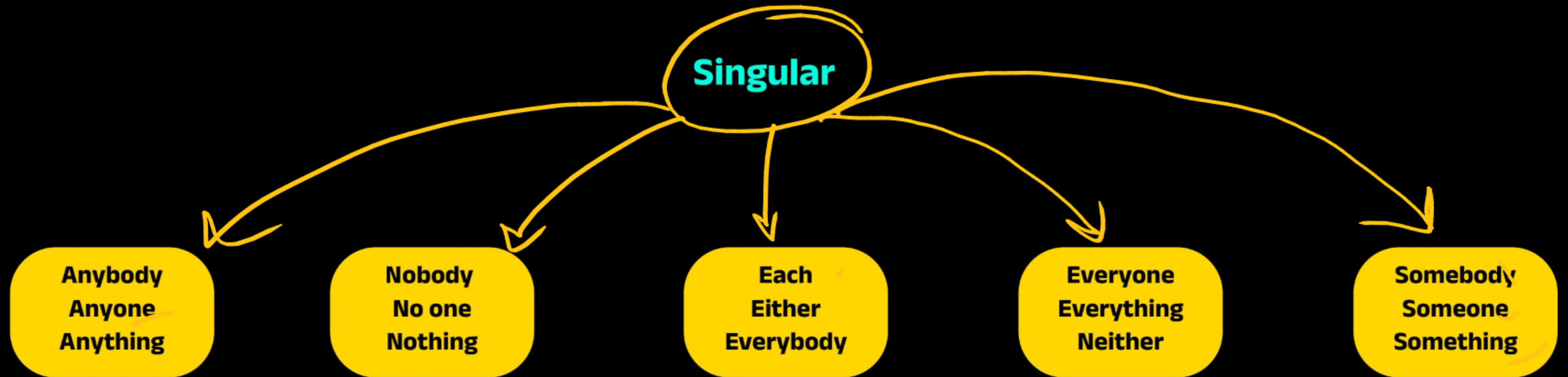
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Subject-Verb Concord

5 Indefinite Pronouns

→ 85% - 90% Singular Nature

He/She/They/It/...



Singular subjects take singular verbs

SINGULAR SUBJECT + SINGULAR VERB

Subject-Verb Concord

5. Indefinite Pronouns

Singular subjects take singular verbs

SINGULAR SUBJECT + SINGULAR VERB

Examples

(i) Someone **has** stolen my ring.

(ii) Everyone **has** a virtue and a vice.

(i) Someone **have** stolen my ring.

(ii) Everyone **have** a virtue and vice.

(0/-) - Plural.

Subject-Verb Concord

5. EXCEPTION: Some indefinite pronouns are plural and always take plural verbs.

Both, Few, Many, Several, Others... + PLURAL VERB

Examples

(i) Have you met the Simpson brothers? Both are so tall!

(i) Have you met the Simpson brothers? Both is so tall!

Subject-Verb Concord

6. Either of/Neither of

When used as a SUBJECT of a sentence,

EITHER OF OR NEITHER OF + SINGULAR VERB

Examples

(i) Neither of the flowers is as pretty as the ones last year.

(ii) Either of us is capable of winning the race.

(i) Neither of the flowers **are** as pretty as the ones last year.

(ii) Either of us **are** capable of winning the race.

Subject-Verb Concord

6. Either/or or Neither /nor + Verb of the closest subject

Examples

(i) Either the Principal or the teachers **are** talking to the students.

(i) Neither the eggs nor the chicken **was** saved in the storm.

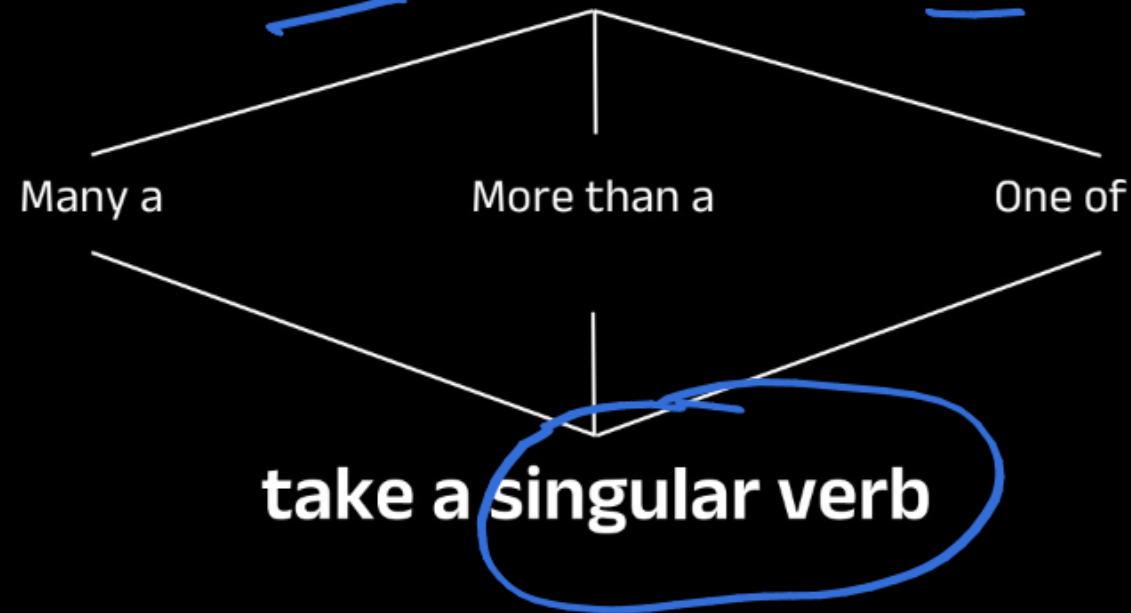
(i) Either the Principal or the teachers **is** talking to the students.

(i) Neither the eggs nor the chicken **were** saved in the storm.

→ Either the ^{S₁}Princi OR the ^{S₂(P)}teachers ^{are} going to the meet
 Either the ^{S₁}teachers or the ^{S₂}Princi ^{is} going to the meeting.

Subject-Verb Concord

7. Many a/More than a/One of...



More than an apple was kept

Examples

(i) One of the students **is** absent today.

(i) One of the students **are** absent today.

Subject-Verb Concord

8. Not only..But also

When a sentence uses NOT ONLY..BUT ALSO, the verb agrees with the closer subject.

Examples

(i) Not only ^{S, (P)} dogs but also ^{P, (P)} cat are ^{is} available at the animal shelter.

(ii) Not only my dresses but also her dress is missing from the cupboard.

(i) Not only dogs but also cats **is** available at the animal shelter.

(ii) Not only my dresses but also her dress **are** missing from the cupboard.

Subject-Verb Concord

#Don't Forget

In sentences that begin with 'here', 'there', the true subject usually follows the verb.

For example-

Here are the chocolates

There is a puddle on the road.

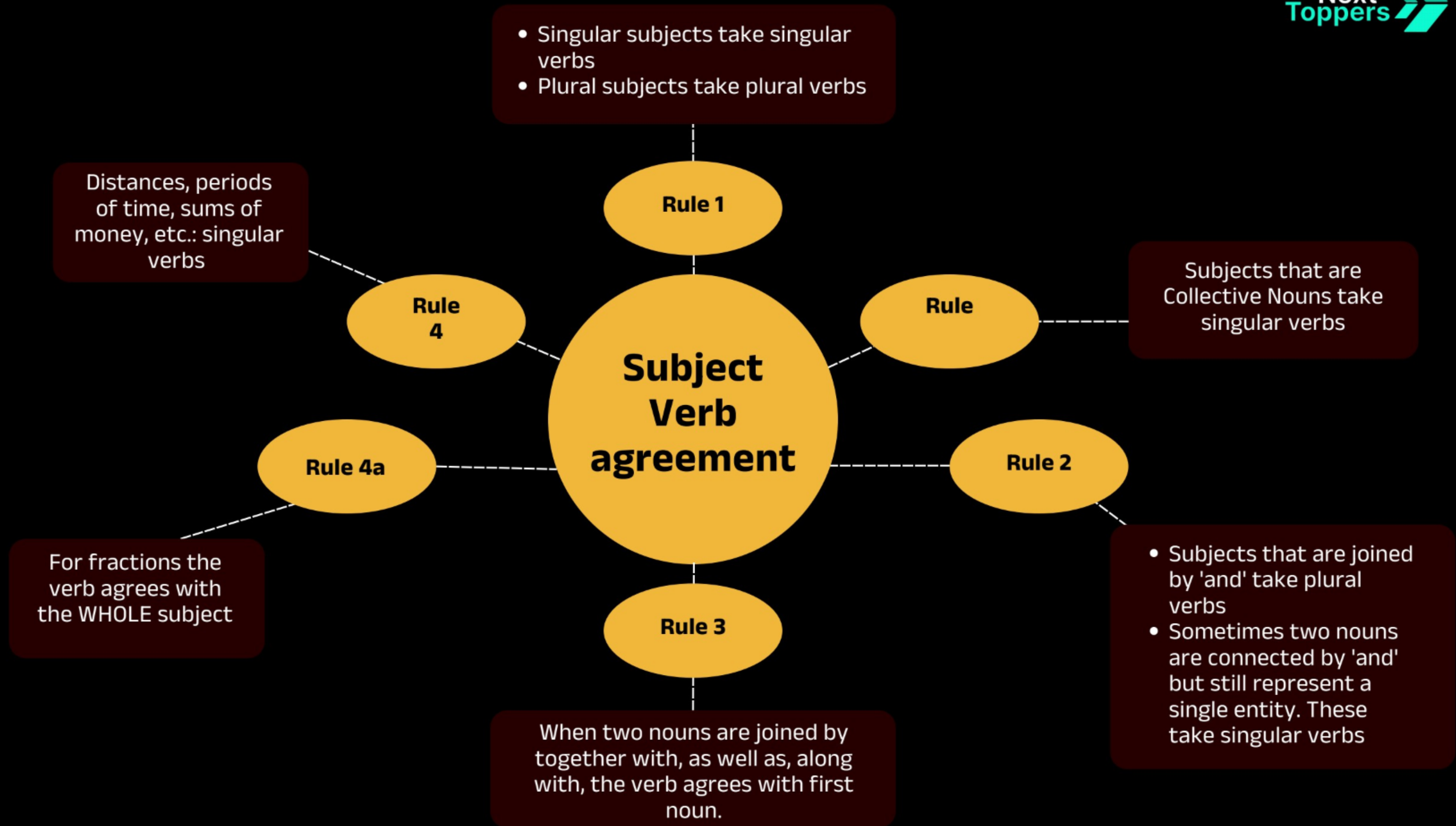
S + V + O
H/There + V + S + O

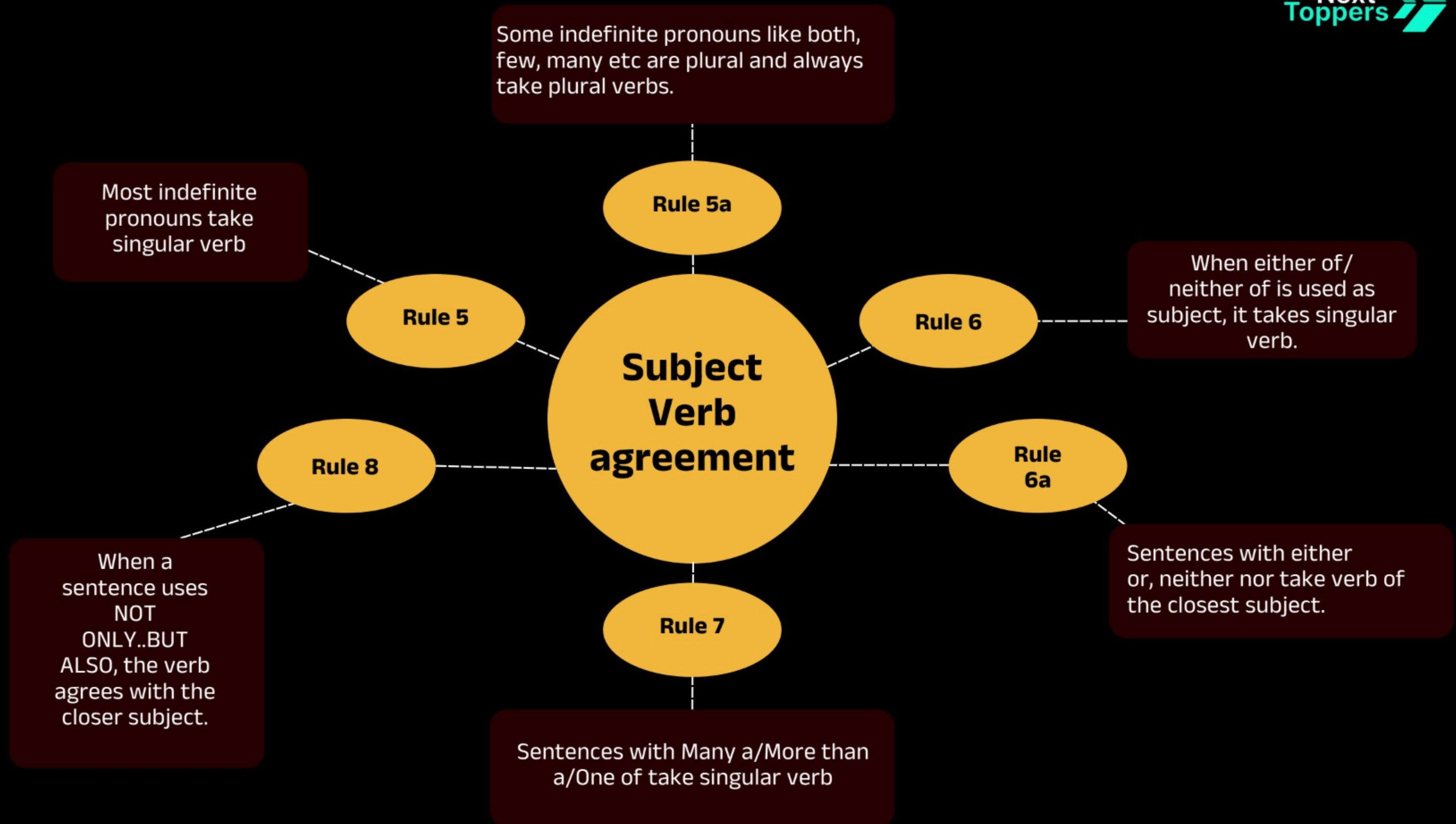
In sentences that express a wish, request, or contrary to fact, the word 'were' is used instead of 'was'.

For example-

I wish my sister **were** here.

Aditya requested that she **raise** her glass.





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